



USER MANUAL

Live Show Playback & MIDI Show Control

Version 1.0.1

AD Sound & Lighting

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1 Introduction

Cue Sync is a professional stage playback application built for live dance and theatrical performances. It combines a multi-track cue timeline, precision fade shaping, and MIDI Show Control (MSC) output to grandMA lighting consoles — everything a stage manager or sound operator needs to run a show reliably, night after night.

This manual is organized the way you will actually use the software: it starts with Show Mode, the screen you will spend the most time in while running a live performance, then covers how the software talks to your grandMA console, and finally walks through the Edit screen where a show is built in the first place — including a full reference of every button and control.

GOOD TO KNOW

Cue Sync is fully offline. No internet connection is required to run a show — only the one-time activation step needs you to send an email.

2 Installation

Cue Sync is available for Windows and macOS.

Windows

1. Run the CueSync-Setup-Windows.exe installer.
2. Choose an installation folder, or accept the default.
3. Desktop and Start Menu shortcuts are created automatically.

macOS

1. Unzip the downloaded CueSync-Mac.zip file.
2. Drag Cue Sync.app into your Applications folder.
3. Right-click the app and choose Open the first time, to allow it to run.

3 Activation

Every copy of Cue Sync must be activated once per computer before it can be used. Activation is machine-locked — a serial issued for one computer will not work on another.

Activate Cue Sync

This copy needs to be activated for this computer before it can be used.

NAME: * EMAIL: *

Your name you@example.com

THIS COMPUTER'S MACHINE ID

7263-1D83-7093-D988 Copy Email

Send this Machine ID to cuesyncshow@gmail.com to receive an Activation Serial for this computer. Each serial only works on the machine it was issued for.

ACTIVATION SERIAL

LSD - XXXX - XXXX - XXXX - XXXX

Activate

Quit

When you first launch the app, you will see the screen above. To activate:

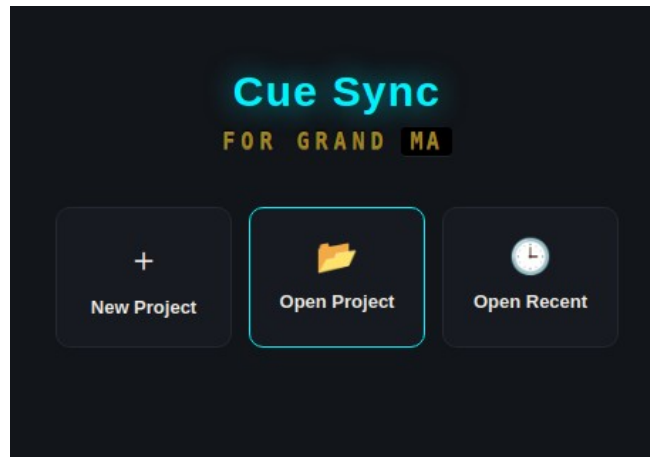
1. Fill in your Name and Email — both are required.
2. Click Email next to the Machine ID box. This opens a pre-filled email to your supplier with your Machine ID already included.
3. Send the email and wait for your Activation Serial to be sent back to you.
4. Paste the serial into the Activation Serial field and click Activate.

NOTE

Once activated, you will not be asked again on this computer — even after restarting the app. Re-activation is only needed after a full uninstall and reinstall.

4 Getting Started

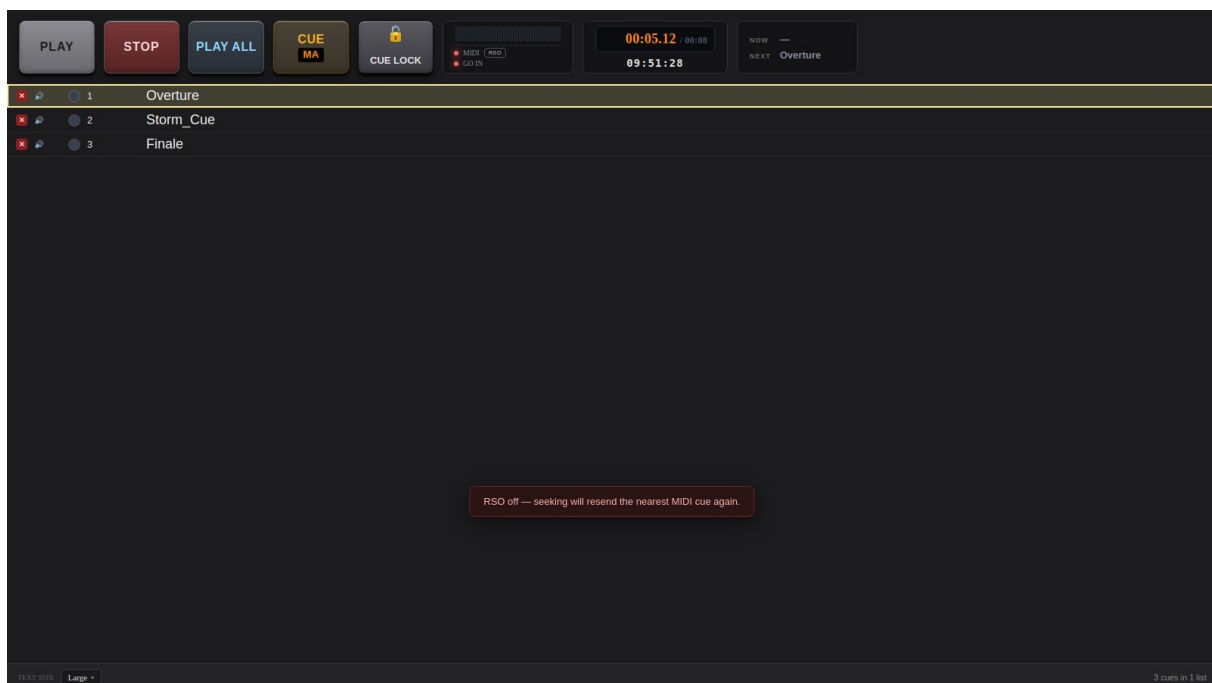
After activation (or on every normal launch), the app briefly shows its loading screen, then presents three ways to begin:



- New Project — opens an empty show, ready for you to drag in songs.
- Open Project — opens the standard file browser to load a previously saved project file.
- Open Recent — automatically reopens your most recently saved project.

5 Show Mode — Running a Live Show

Show Mode is the screen you use while actually running a performance. It strips away every editing tool and presents a large, simple cue list with big transport buttons — designed to be read at a glance and operated with confidence under pressure, whether you are watching the stage or the console.



5.1 The Transport Buttons

Five buttons run across the top-left of the screen. Each one is large and color-coded so it can be identified without reading it.

Button	What it does
PLAY	Plays the currently marked (highlighted) song. If that song is already playing, pressing PLAY again pauses it in place — it will not jump ahead to the next song. The button turns solid green while something is playing.
STOP	Stops playback immediately. Double-clicking STOP additionally resets every song's playhead back to its very start, so the next PLAY begins from zero.
PLAY ALL	Toggles an unattended sequence mode: every song in the list plays through in order, back-to-back, without you needing to press PLAY between them. The button lights up cyan while active.
CUE (MA)	Sends a single manual GO command to the console immediately, independent of the song timeline — useful for a cue that is not tied to a specific moment in the music, or as a manual backup trigger.
CUE LOCK	A safety lock for the CUE button. When locked, its border turns into a red striped pattern and CUE presses are ignored until it is unlocked again — preventing an accidental knock or misclick from firing a cue mid-show. Can optionally require a password to unlock (see Section 9.4).

5.2 The Cue List

Every song in the project appears as one row, in the same order as the Edit screen's timeline. Each row shows, from left to right: a small ✕ to remove the song from the list, a play-state icon, the song's position number, and its name.

The play-state icon has three distinct looks:

- A grey speaker icon — idle, not currently queued or playing.
- A blinking cyan play icon — pending: this song is queued to start next once the current one finishes.
- A solid green pulsing icon — actively playing right now.

Click any row to mark it — its name and the whole row highlight in light yellow with a matching border. Marking a song does not play it; it simply tells PLAY (and the Space bar) which song to act on next. You can also move the mark with the Up and Down arrow keys, which is often faster than reaching for the mouse.

While a song is playing, its row additionally shows a live mini spectrum meter next to its name — a set of small vertical bars that react to the real audio frequencies of that song in real time, giving an at-a-glance confirmation that audio is actually flowing.

Once the playhead inside a song passes one of its cues, that cue is considered "fired" for this playback pass; this is reflected on the Edit screen's waveform view, where the cue marker turns from amber to green.

5.3 Now / Next

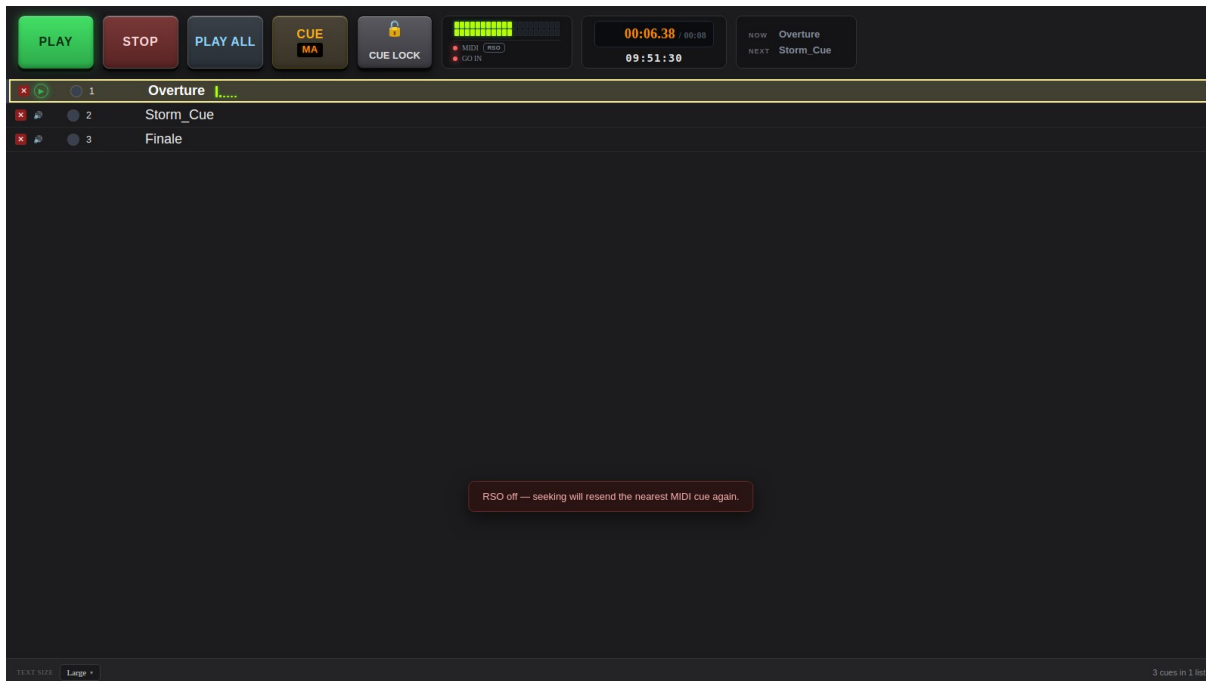
The panel in the top-right corner always shows two things: NOW, the name of whatever is currently playing (or a dash if nothing is), and NEXT, the song that will play immediately afterward — normally the one right below it in the list. This lets you confirm at a glance what is coming up without scanning the whole cue list.

5.4 MIDI & Level Status

Next to the clock, a small box shows two status lights (MIDI and GO IN), the RSO toggle right beside the MIDI label, and a stereo LED level meter showing real-time playback loudness. These are covered in full detail in Section 6, MIDI Show Control & grandMA Integration, since they are all about how Cue Sync talks to your console.

5.5 Text Size

The TEXT SIZE control in the bottom-left corner of Show Mode lets you enlarge the song names in the cue list — Small, Medium, Large, or X-Large. This is genuinely useful when the operator's screen is mounted further away, or the booth lighting is dim. Your choice is remembered automatically the next time you open the app.

**TIP**

Show Mode is the app's default screen — it is what you see immediately after choosing New Project, Open Project, or Open Recent at startup. You do not need to navigate to it manually.

6 MIDI Show Control & grandMA Integration

Cue Sync's core purpose is to keep audio and lighting perfectly synchronized. It does this using MIDI Show Control (MSC), an industry-standard protocol that lets one device send timed "GO" commands to another over a MIDI connection. In this case, Cue Sync is the sender, and your grandMA console is the receiver.

6.1 How a Cue Reaches the Console

Every cue you place on a song's timeline (see Section 7.6) has a cue number. When playback reaches that exact point in the music, Cue Sync sends an MSC "GO" message for that cue number out through the selected MIDI Output. On the grandMA side, that cue number should correspond to a cue in the console's own cue list — so pressing play on the music and having the console fire cues at the right musical moments becomes entirely automatic, with no operator needing to press GO by hand during the show.

1. Build your lighting cues on the grandMA console, numbered to match the moments you want to trigger in the music.
2. In Cue Sync, place a cue marker at each of those same moments on the song's waveform, using a matching cue number.
3. Connect the MIDI Output to the console (Section 6.2) and run the show — cues fire themselves in sync with the music.

6.2 Connecting to the Console

Open File → Preferences to choose your MIDI devices:

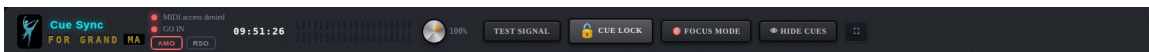
- MIDI Output (to grandMA) — the connection Cue Sync uses to send GO commands. This is normally either a physical MIDI interface cabled to the console, or a virtual MIDI port (such as an IAC Driver on macOS or loopMIDI on Windows) if both are running on the same computer.
- MIDI Input (from grandMA) — an optional second connection that allows the console to trigger playback in the other direction, described in Section 6.3.

Both selections are saved automatically and restored the next time you open the app — there is no need to reconnect your devices at the start of every session.

6.3 GO IN — Remote Triggering from the Console

The GO IN status light reflects the MIDI Input connection. When it is active, the console can send its own trigger back to Cue Sync to start or advance playback — useful when the lighting operator, rather than the sound operator, is the one calling the go for a scene. This is entirely optional; most shows only need the one-way MIDI Output connection described above.

6.4 Reading the Status Lights



The MIDI and GO IN lights (visible on both the Edit screen and Show Mode) are simple at-a-glance indicators:

- Red — not connected. Either no device is selected in Preferences, or the selected device is unavailable.
- Green — connected and ready.

6.5 The AMO Button — Emergency MIDI Disconnect

Directly below the status lights sits the AMO button, a dedicated kill switch for MIDI communication. It is intentionally simple and fast to use under pressure:

- Click once to instantly disconnect both MIDI Output and Input. Its border turns red and blinks continuously as a constant visual reminder that MIDI is currently cut.
- Click again to reconnect — it restores the exact same devices that were connected before, and its border returns to a steady green.

This is the fastest way to stop Cue Sync from sending anything to the console mid-show, without needing to open Preferences and change dropdown selections.

TIP

AMO can be password-protected from Preferences, alongside CUE and CUE LOCK — see Section 9.4. This is useful if you want to prevent it from being triggered accidentally, while still allowing a trusted operator to use it deliberately.

6.6 Testing Without a Console

The TEST SIGNAL button in the Edit screen's top toolbar sends a single test MSC message out through the currently selected MIDI Output, without needing an actual cue on the timeline. Use it to confirm the console is receiving commands correctly before a show, without needing to play any audio.

6.7 RSO — Resync-on-Seek Off

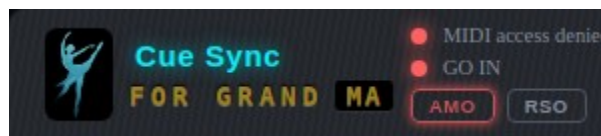
By default, whenever you seek within a song — dragging the playhead, clicking the ruler, or jumping to a new position in any way — Cue Sync automatically re-sends an MSC GO command for the nearest cue at or before that new position. This "resync" keeps the console's state matched to wherever you've landed in the music, and is normally exactly what you want during a live show.

Sometimes, though, you just want to look around the timeline — check where a cue sits, scrub back to re-listen to a transition — without re-triggering anything on the console. That is exactly what the RSO button is for.

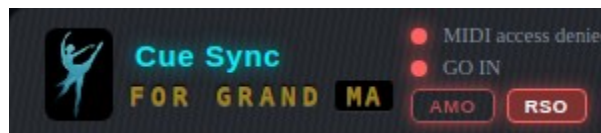
State	Behavior
Off (default)	Seeking resends the nearest MSC GO command, exactly as described above. This is the normal, always-in-sync behavior.
On (red)	Seeking within a song sends nothing to the console at all — you can move the playhead freely to inspect the timeline without affecting the lighting state.

RSO appears in two places, and both are always in sync — toggling one immediately updates the other:

- Edit screen — directly beside the AMO button.
- Show Mode — directly beside the MIDI status label.



Click it once to turn RSO on — its border turns solid red as a clear, constant reminder that seeking is temporarily silent:



The same toggle, shown here in Show Mode, right next to the MIDI status:



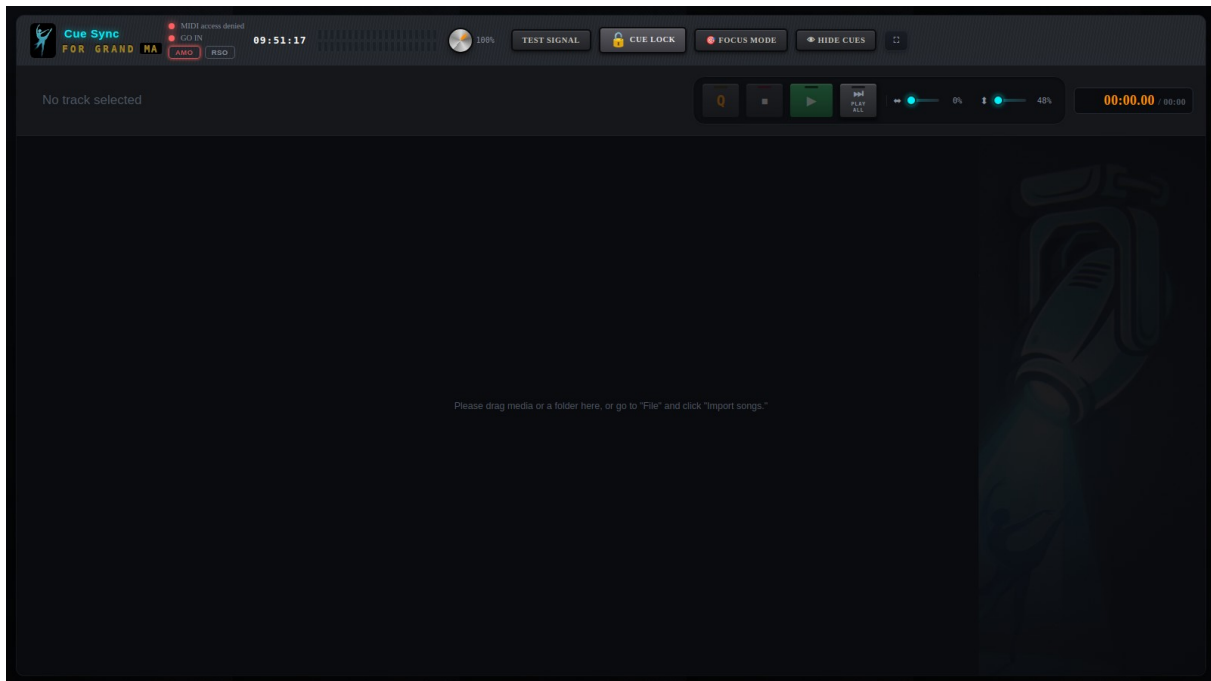
NOTE

RSO only affects seeking. It does not change how cues fire during normal playback, and it does not affect the CUE (MA) manual trigger, PLAY, or PLAY ALL — those still communicate with the console exactly as usual.

7 The Edit Screen — Building a Show

The Edit screen is where a show is actually built: importing songs, arranging them on the timeline, placing cues, and shaping fades. Everything here is preparation; the finished result is what you will run later in Show Mode.

A fresh, empty project looks like this:



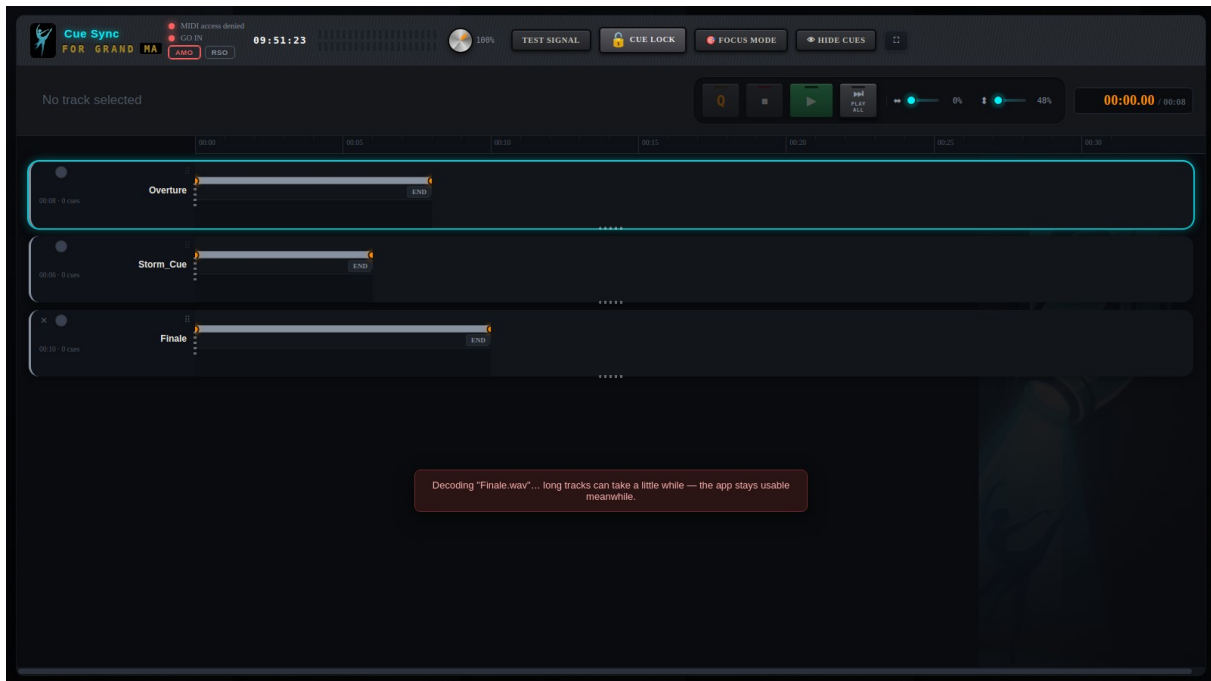
7.1 Importing Songs

You can add songs in three ways:

- Drag audio files directly onto the window.
- Drag an entire folder of songs — Cue Sync automatically finds every audio file inside it, including in subfolders, so you can organize your show's music in folders on disk and just drop the whole folder in at once.
- Go to File → Import Songs to browse for files using the standard file picker.

Supported formats: MP3, WAV, M4A, AAC, OGG, FLAC, AIFF, and WMA.

Once songs are added, each one appears as its own row on the timeline, with its waveform, duration, and cue count:



7.2 The Top Toolbar

The toolbar spans the top of the Edit screen and is available at all times.

Control	What it does
Logo / brand	Displays the app name and "FOR GRAND MA" — purely informational.
MIDI status light	Shows whether the MIDI Output to the console is connected. See Section 6.4.
GO IN status light	Shows whether the MIDI Input from the console is connected. See Section 6.3.
AMO	One-click MIDI disconnect / reconnect switch. See Section 6.5.
RSO	When active (red), seeking within a song will not resend a MIDI GO command. See Section 6.7.
Clock	The current wall-clock time. Click it to open a large, resizable clock window — useful on a second monitor visible to the whole crew.
LED meter	A stereo (L/R) level meter showing real-time playback loudness, with green/yellow/red segments.
Zoom dial (%)	Shows and controls the current horizontal zoom level of the timeline.

TEST SIGNAL	Sends a single test MSC message to the console, without needing a cue or any audio playing. See Section 6.6.
CUE LOCK	Locks the Q (mark) button to prevent accidentally adding cues. Striped red border when locked.
FOCUS MODE	Expands whichever song is selected to full height, revealing its detailed per-song controls. See Section 7.7.
HIDE CUES	Temporarily hides all cue markers from every waveform, for an uncluttered view of the audio itself.
Fullscreen toggle	Expands the app window to fill the entire screen.

7.3 The Transport Bar

Directly below the toolbar sits the transport bar, which controls playback of whichever song is currently active.

Control	What it does
Track name	Shows the name of the currently selected song, or "No track selected".
Q	Drops a cue marker at the current playhead position on the active song. Same action as pressing M on the keyboard.
Stop	Stops playback of the active song.
Play	Plays the active song from its current playhead position.
Play All	Plays every song on the timeline in sequence, back-to-back.
Horizontal zoom slider	Stretches or compresses the timeline view — zoom in for precise cue placement, zoom out to see a whole song at once.
Vertical zoom slider	Adjusts the height of each track row, useful when working with many songs at once.
Timecode display	Shows the current playhead position and total duration of the active song.

7.4 Track Rows

Each imported song occupies one row on the timeline. From left to right, a row includes:

- A small × to delete the song from the project.

- A drag handle (: :) to reorder songs by dragging them up or down.
- A color swatch — click it to open a palette and assign a color to the song, which is then reflected throughout the app, including its row highlight and its waveform trim/fade shading.
- The song name (double-click to rename it).
- Its duration and cue count.
- The waveform itself, with cue markers, trim handles, and fade shaping overlaid on it.

Double-clicking a row (outside of these controls) selects that song and scrolls it into view, making it the active track for the transport bar above.

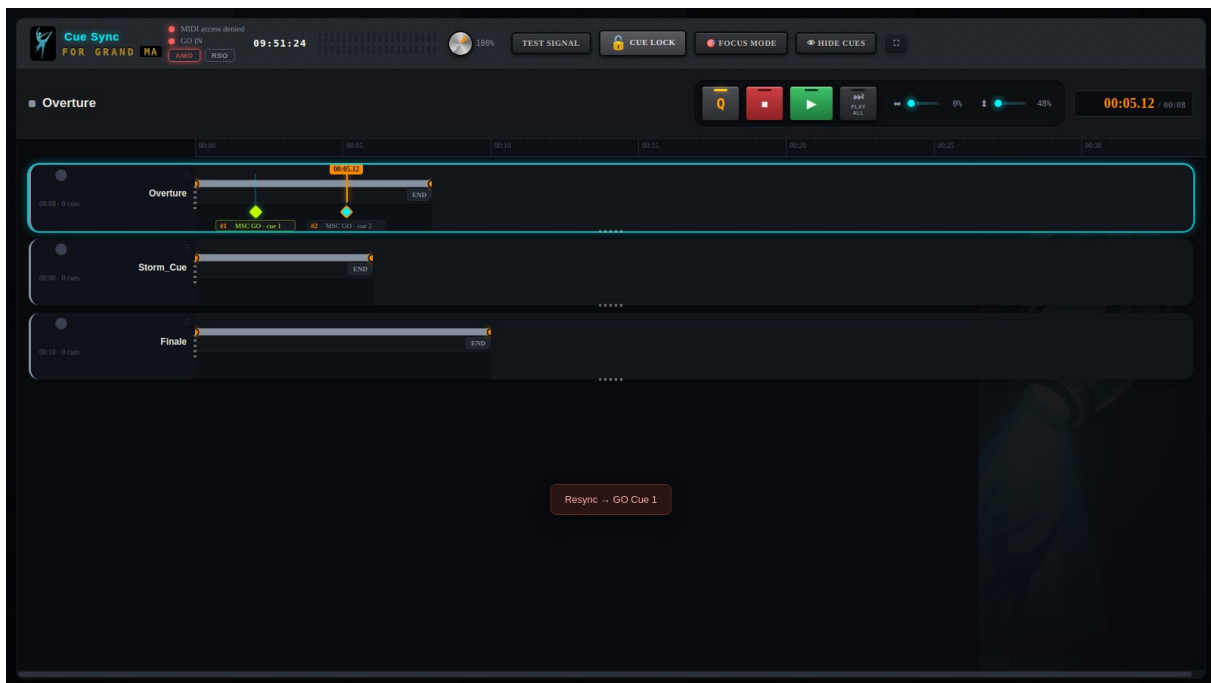
7.5 Working with Cues

A cue is a timed trigger point within a song, used to send an MSC GO command to the console at an exact musical moment (see Section 6.1 for the full MIDI Show Control explanation).

To add a cue:

1. Click a song's row to select it, and click on its waveform to move the playhead to the desired position.
2. Click the Q button in the transport bar (or press the M key) to drop a cue marker at the playhead.

Cues appear as small diamond markers below the waveform, each labeled with its cue number:



Cues can be dragged left or right along the waveform to fine-tune their timing, or deleted individually. Once the playhead passes a cue during playback, its marker turns from amber to green — confirming it has fired.

7.6 Trimming & Fades

Trim handles let you cut unwanted material from the very start or end of a song — an intro count-in, or silence at the tail, for example — without permanently editing the audio file itself. Anything trimmed away is hidden from the waveform entirely, and the song's displayed duration always reflects the trimmed length, not the original file's length. Trim handles are only available in Focus Mode (Section 7.7), to keep the main timeline uncluttered.

Fade In and Fade Out durations (in seconds) can be set for every song, with a choice of four fade shapes:

- Linear — a straight, constant fade.
- Ease In — starts slowly, then fades quickly toward the end.
- Ease Out — fades quickly at first, then tapers off gently.
- S-Curve — smooth and gradual at both ends, matching how professional DAWs shape fades.

7.7 Focus Mode

Focus Mode expands a single selected song to full height, revealing a detailed panel of per-song controls not shown on the main timeline:



Control	What it does
VOL	This song's individual playback volume.
PAN	Stereo left/right balance for this song.
FADE IN / FADE OUT	Duration in seconds for this song's fade in and fade out.
CURVE	Chooses the fade shape (Linear, Ease In, Ease Out, or S-Curve) — see Section 7.6.
Equalizer	A 5-band graphic equalizer. Drag any of the five points up or down to boost or cut that frequency band.
Compressor	An ON/OFF toggle with a Threshold control, plus a live gain-reduction (GR) readout in dB, for taming a song's dynamic range.
Delete All Cues	Removes every cue marker from this song in one action. Asks for confirmation first.

7.8 Color-Coding Songs

Assigning a distinct color to each song (via its color swatch) makes a busy timeline — or a long Show Mode cue list — much easier to scan at a glance. Colors are shared consistently between the Edit screen and Show Mode.

8 The File Menu

Menu Item	What it does
New	Starts a fresh, empty project. Prompts to save your current project first if it has unsaved changes.
Save	Saves the current project. If it has never been saved before, opens a Save As dialog.
Save As	Always opens a dialog to save the project under a new file name or location.
Open	Opens the standard file browser to load a previously saved project.
Open Recent	Automatically reopens the most recently saved project, with no file browser needed.
Import Songs	Opens the standard file browser to add one or more audio files to the project — the same result as dragging files onto the window.

Preferences	Opens the Preferences window (Section 9).
Key Commands	Opens a reference window listing all keyboard shortcuts.

GOOD TO KNOW

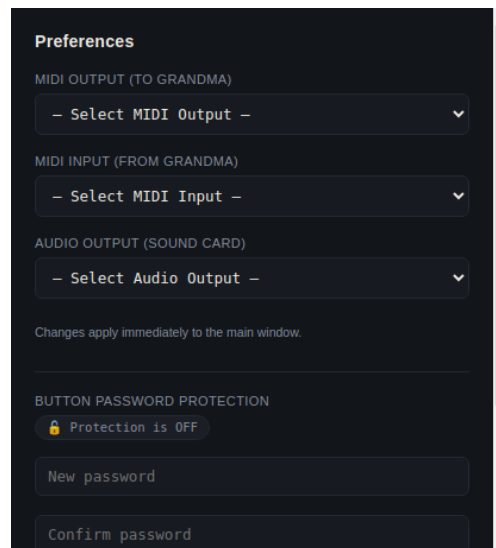
Projects are saved by reference to your original audio files wherever possible, rather than duplicating them — this keeps project files small and saves quickly, even with a large song library.

8.1 The Help Menu

This manual travels with the app itself. Go to Help → User Manual at any time to save a fresh copy of this PDF to your computer — no internet connection required, since it is bundled directly inside the application.

9 Preferences

Open File → Preferences to configure how Cue Sync talks to your lighting console and sound hardware.



9.1 MIDI Output (to grandMA)

Selects the MIDI connection used to send GO commands to the console. See Section 6.2 for full details on connecting to grandMA.

9.2 MIDI Input (from grandMA)

Selects the MIDI connection used to let the console remotely trigger playback. See Section 6.3.

9.3 Audio Output

Chooses which sound card or audio interface plays the show's audio.

9.4 Button Password Protection

Sets an optional password that, once configured, will be required to use the PLAY ALL, CUE LOCK, and AMO buttons — a safeguard against an unauthorized or accidental press of a critical, show-affecting control. Leave this blank to keep all three buttons unprotected.

NOTE

All Preferences changes apply immediately and are remembered automatically the next time you open the app — there is no separate Save button.

10 Keyboard Shortcuts

Key	Action
Space	Play / Pause the marked (Show Mode) or active (Edit Mode) song
↑ / ↓	Show Mode: move the selection to the previous / next song
M	Drop a cue marker at the playhead
Ctrl/Cmd + S	Save the current project
Shift + Ctrl/Cmd + S	Save the project as a new file
Ctrl/Cmd + Alt/Opt + Shift + G	Open the hidden Serial Generator tool (for issuing activation serials)

11 Troubleshooting & FAQ

The activation screen appears again after reinstalling

This is expected behavior on Windows: uninstalling the app also clears its saved activation, so a fresh install will ask for the serial again. Simply repeat the activation steps in Section 3 — the same Machine ID and Serial will still work.

No MIDI devices appear in Preferences

Confirm your MIDI interface or virtual MIDI cable is connected and powered on before opening Preferences. If it was connected after the app launched, close and reopen the Preferences window to refresh the device list.

Cues are not triggering anything on the console

Confirm the MIDI status light is green (Section 6.4), that the cue numbers in Cue Sync actually match cue numbers that exist in the console's own cue list, and that AMO has not been left in its disconnected (red, blinking) state.

A song shows "Decoding..." and won't play yet

Very long audio files take a few moments to decode after being imported. The app remains fully usable while this happens in the background — the song will become playable automatically once decoding finishes.

I dropped a folder but no songs were added

Confirm the folder contains supported audio formats (MP3, WAV, M4A, AAC, OGG, FLAC, AIFF, or WMA). Unsupported files inside the folder are silently skipped, and a notification will tell you how many were skipped.

12 Support

For activation requests, questions, or support, contact:

cuesyncshow@gmail.com

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